Gemcitabine and cisplatin induction before chemoradiotherapy

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00903 · Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before your first visit

Full blood count, kidney and liver tests; review medicines, allergies, weight, oral intake and symptoms. Review nerve symptoms and hearing; audiology when indicated. Cisplatin eligibility includes adequate kidney function.

STEP 2

Time in the unit

Gemcitabine runs over 30 minutes, followed on Day 1 by cisplatin over 1 hour. Prescribed fluids before and after cisplatin lengthen the visit. Day 8 is gemcitabine alone.

STEP 3

Keep one calendar

The NCCP plan starts chemoradiotherapy 21–28 days after Day 1 of the last induction cycle, subject to review and recovery. This is measured from the first day, not from Day 8 or the end of that cycle. The later regimen has its own prescription.

STEP 4

Leaving the unit

Confirm the next tests, medicines, treatment dates and verified daytime and out-of-hours contact numbers.

STEP 5

Practical help

Ask about transport, work, costs, communication needs and whether a support person can attend.

Sources: NCCP 00903 v1: retrieved official regimen. Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.